AMERICAN UNIVERSITY OF BEIRUT

SULIMAN S. OLAYAN SCHOOL OF BUSINESS

Executive Education

FAMILY BUSINESS GOVERNANCE PROGRAM

Governance is not about control. It's about continuity. Family businesses are built on legacy, values, and relationships; but sustaining them across generations requires governance that is both strategic and deeply human.

REGISTER HERE!

Or contact us at AUB OSB Executive Education
phone: +961-1-374 374 ext. 3748 | email: gs52@aub.edu.lb

OVERVIEW

Family Business Governance Program, developed by the American University of Beirut, Suliman S. Olayan School of Business (OSB), blends academic rigor with real-world relevance, helping participants navigate the unique dynamics that make family enterprises both powerful and fragile. This immersive three-day program equips family business leaders with the tools and frameworks needed to design governance systems that manage complexity and ensure continuity without compromising family harmony.

LEAD INSTRUCTOR
GEORGES SAMARA, PHD

Georges Samara, Ph.D., is an Associate Professor of Entrepreneurship and Family Business at the Olayan School of Business, American University of Beirut. He is the winner of the extraordinary doctorate award, along with more than 10 international awards for his published research. His research has focused on family business, entrepreneurship, and corporate social responsibility and sustainability, and he has published more than 50 academic articles, editorials, books and book chapters. For more than eight years, he consults family businesses in the Gulf, where he has developed extensive practice in advising, coaching, and guiding family enterprises through complex transitions.

His expertise extends to preparing comprehensive reports and expert opinions for judicial bodies, offering courts nuanced insights into family business governance, succession disputes, and sustainability strategies. Dr. Samara brings a unique blend of academic rigor and practical engagement.

HOW YOU BENEFIT

- Explain the distinctive characteristics of family businesses and assess how family ownership and values influence governance structures.
- Analyze the roles and processes of boards in family-owned enterprises while evaluating the impact of family involvement on board effectiveness.
- Evaluate how family ownership considerations shape strategic decision-making in family businesses.
- Recognize the role of women in governance and leadership, identify barriers to their participation and propose actions.
- Integrate legacy and values into governance frameworks ensuring sustainability across generations.

AACSB ACCREDITED

WHY THIS PROGRAM

1. Innovative. It delivers an updated perspective on governance tailored specifically to family-owned businesses.
2. Practical. It provides you with hands-on experience of the application of tools and techniques.
3. Short and Effective. It is designed to suit your busy schedule and aims to provide you with the know-how in 3 days.
4. Highly engaging. It includes case studies, interactive discussions, hands-on exercises, and individual contributions.

WHO SHOULD ENROLL

- AUB alumni, looking to reconnect with the AUB network and renew their learning journey.
- Family business owners and shareholders.
- Board members and senior executives of family-owned firms
- Next-generation leaders preparing for governance roles.
- Advisors and professionals working closely with family enterprises.

Participants generally come from different sectors and industries. Proficiency in spoken and written English is necessary.

Duration: 3 days

Dates:

Fees: $1,000

Fees for AUB Alumni: $800

Location: American University of Beirut Suliman S. Olayan School of Business (OSB) campus, Beirut – Lebanon